Champions Challenge – Insights & Recommendations

Summary

The challenge worked. It lifted engagement by about a quarter and stopped a slide that was already under way. The lift faded in the second half, though, and the users who were struggling before the challenge mostly kept struggling.

- **Engagement:** average learning went from 4.95 to 6.14 hrs per user per week (+24%). 62% of users learned more during the challenge than in the 8 weeks before.
- **Retention:** 85% of users were active in week 1 and 75% in week 8. Weekly goal completion peaked at 65% in week 2 and dropped to 45% by week 7.
- **Rewards:** 174 of 326 valid users (53%) hit the target. The top 3 are user_141 (Laptop), user_218 (Tablet) and user_309 (Smart Watch). user_218 and user_309 tied on hours and were split by lessons completed.
- **Early signal:** users who hit both of their first two weekly goals achieved the target 81% of the time. Users who hit neither achieved it 6% of the time.
- **Data:** one bulk system update gave every user 4.27 free hours on 26 Oct. Without removing it, 23 more users would have "won" a hamper.

All figures exclude 4 users with impossible activity logs and the bulk-credited records (see Data quality).

Did the challenge improve engagement?

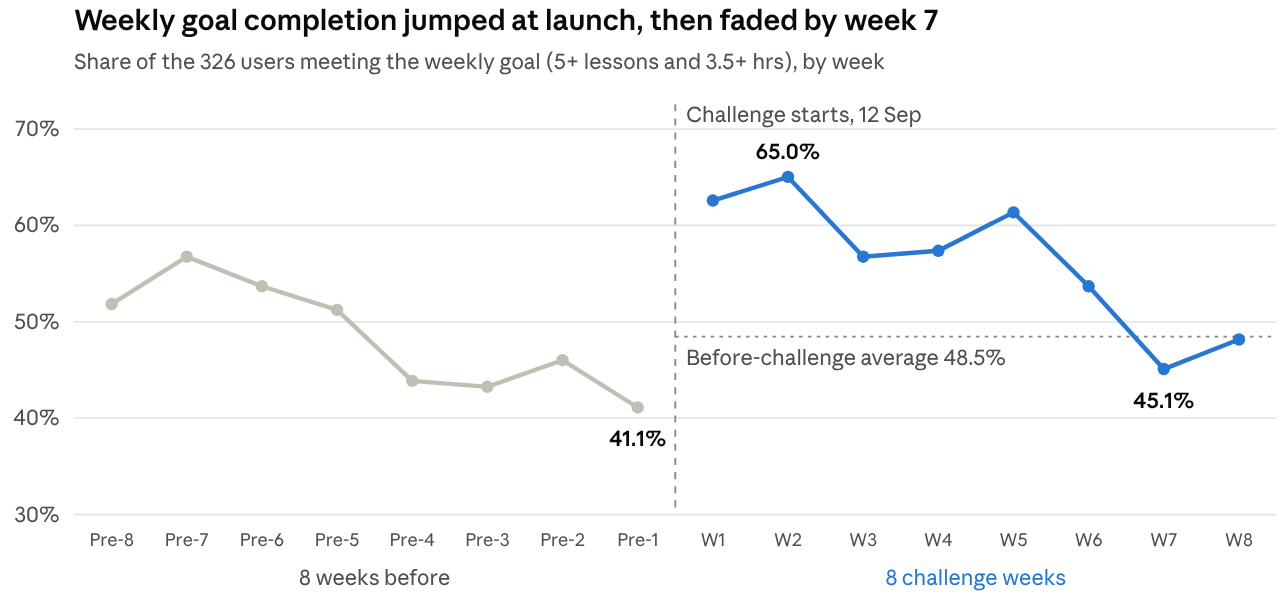
Yes. Every engagement measure improved when comparing the 8 challenge weeks with the 8 weeks just before them (18 Jul – 11 Sep) for the same 326 users.

Per user, per week	Before	During	Change
Learning hours	4.95	6.14	+24%
Lessons completed	7.17	8.34	+16%
Share of users active	74.9%	82.2%	+7.3 pts
Share meeting the weekly-goal bar	48.5%	56.2%	+7.7 pts

Per user, per week	Before	During	Change
Learning days per active week	3.90	4.23	+0.33

The gain isn't driven by a few heavy users. The median user's 8-week total rose from 37.9 to 45.5 hrs, and 62% of users increased their hours. A paired Wilcoxon test puts the difference well beyond chance ($p < 0.001$).

The timing matters too. In the 8 weeks before the challenge, the share of users who would have met the weekly goal was drifting down, from 52–57% in late July to 41% in the week before launch. The challenge reversed that straight away.



user_weeks table · 326 valid users × 16 weeks, 18 Jul – 6 Nov 2022, outliers and bulk-credited records removed

The weekly goal was applied to the baseline weeks only as a yardstick, since nobody was chasing it then. Even so, it's the cleanest way to compare like with like.

How is retention?

Retention held up well in activity but not in goal completion. 75% of users were still learning in week 8, but fewer than half were hitting their weekly goal by then.

- **Weekly activity** stayed at 80–86% for the first six weeks, then slipped to 80% in week 7 and 75% in week 8. 245 of 326 users were active in the final week.
- **Weekly goal completion** peaked at 65% in week 2 and fell to 45% in week 7. Week 7 (24–30 Oct) was Diwali week, which likely explains part of that dip.

- **Consistency improved.** 48% of users were active in all 8 challenge weeks, against 38% in the 8 weeks before. 48 users hit their goal every single week.
- **Drop-outs came late.** 72 users stopped before the end, half of them only in the last week. 9 users never logged any learning during the challenge.

The first two weeks predict the outcome well enough to act on:

Weekly goals hit in weeks 1–2	Users	Went on to achieve the target
2 of 2	170	81%
1 of 2	76	41%
0 of 2	80	6%

That gives the CS team a list of 156 at-risk users by day 14, while there are still six weeks left to recover.

Post-challenge retention can't be measured yet because the data stops on 6 Nov. The obvious next check is whether November activity stays above the July–August baseline.

Rewards and winners

174 users hit the target and get a hamper. The top 3 also get a gadget. Another 114 get a goodie based on how many weekly goals they hit, and 38 users with no weekly goals get nothing.

Rank	User	State	Branch	Challenge hrs	Weekly goals	Lessons completed	Target reached	Prize
1	user_141	Kerala	Non-Tech	160.54	8	227	12 Oct	Laptop + Hamper
2	user_218	Telangana	Non-Tech	153.53	8	188	11 Oct	Tablet + Hamper
3	user_309	Andhra Pradesh	Tech	153.53	8	177	14 Oct	Smart Watch + Hamper

Tie-break. user_218 and user_309 have identical hours and both hit 8/8 goals. The ranking order is: total challenge hours, then weekly goals, then lessons completed during the challenge, then the earlier date the target was reached. user_218 takes 2nd on lessons

completed (188 vs 177). The last criterion points the same way: they reached the target 3 days earlier. The next user, user_286, is 16 hrs behind, so 4th place isn't in question.

What to order:

Item	Qty	Who gets it
Laptop	1	Rank 1
Tablet	1	Rank 2
Smart Watch	1	Rank 3
Hamper	174	Everyone who hit the target, top 3 included
Backpack	35	Missed target, 4 weekly goals
Sweatshirt	38	Missed target, 3 weekly goals
T-shirt	22	Missed target, 2 weekly goals
Water Bottle	19	Missed target, 1 weekly goal
Head Phones	0	Missed target, 5 weekly goals

No one qualifies for Head Phones. That tier needs 5 goals with under 20 hrs. It's possible on paper, since 5 × 3.5 = 17.5 hrs, but every user who hit 5 or more goals also passed 20 hrs. In practice, the hours condition didn't decide anyone's result. The user-level dispatch list, with each person's reward, is on the Rewards page of the dashboard.

Who succeeded, and how

Habit predicts success much better than demographics do. Users who already learned regularly before the challenge nearly all made it. The challenge's real win is the 58 users it pulled up from a low base.

Users grouped by before-vs-during behaviour. "High" here means above the median pre-challenge pace of 4.7 hrs a week.

Segment	Users	Achieved target	Median hrs, 8 wks before → during
Consistent high – high before and during	131	95%	55.0 → 70.0
Activated – low before, high during	58	69%	23.1 → 57.1
Dropped off – high before, low during	32	9%	47.9 → 28.4
Consistently low – low before and during	105	6%	16.1 → 15.6

The 105 consistently-low users barely moved. For them the challenge was background noise, and the same format won't reach them next time. The 32 who dropped off were regular learners before. They're worth a direct call to find out what got in the way.

Behaviour that separates achievers:

- **Spread, not bursts.** Achievers learned on 4.9 days in an active week, against 3.2 for everyone else. 95% of weeks where the goal was hit had 3 or more learning days. Only 41% of active weeks that missed the goal did.
- **Missed weeks miss on both counts.** In 65% of active weeks without a goal, users were short on both lessons and hours. So the problem is showing up, not one threshold being slightly too high.
- **Evenings.** 62% of challenge-period learning happened between 6 pm and midnight, up from 56% before, and peaked from 7 to 11 pm.
- **No Sunday cramming.** Sunday's share of weekly hours fell from 14.6% to 11.4% and Thursday's rose. Users spread their effort through the week rather than rushing to the deadline.
- **Past habit.** Of the 41 users who never met the goal bar in the baseline weeks, 7% achieved the target. Of the 66 who met it in 7 or 8 baseline weeks, 85% did.

Demographics don't explain much. By state, achievement ranges from 59.7% (Telangana) and 59.0% (Andhra Pradesh) down to 47.7% (Tamil Nadu) and 46.7% (Karnataka). Gaps by gender (M 55% / F 52%), branch, graduation year and batch are smaller still. None of these differences is statistically significant (chi-square p = 0.36–0.90 with groups of 56–180 users). Telangana's lead mostly reflects heavier learning before the challenge started (median 47.8 hrs vs 31.8–37.3 elsewhere).

Recommendations

Run it again, with the effort aimed at weeks 2, 5 and 6 rather than spread evenly.

1. **Day-14 check-in.** After week 2, flag users with 0–1 goals (156 this time). Give them a CS call or a personal nudge. These users succeed 6–41% of the time, against 81% for those on track, and there are still six weeks left to recover.
2. **Second-half booster.** Goal completion dropped 20 points between week 2 and week 7. Add a halfway reward (for example, a badge or entry into a draw for 4 goals by week 5), and avoid festival weeks or plan around them.
3. **Fix the reward ladder.** The Head Phones tier went unused, and the 20-hr condition never decided anyone's result. Either raise the hours bar (say 28 hrs, i.e. 3.5 × 8) or drop it, and put the goodies at 3, 4 and 5 goals where most near-misses sit.
4. **Re-engage the near-misses.** 35 users hit exactly 4 goals, and all of them logged 23+ hrs. They have the time but not the regularity. A "catch-up week" or an invitation to the next edition with a head start would likely convert many of them.
5. **A different format for low-habit users.** 105 users started low and stayed low (6% success). For them, try smaller weekly goals (for example, 3 lessons, 2 hrs) or study buddies rather than a stretch target.
6. **Time the nudges.** Send reminders around 6–7 pm on weekdays, just before the evening peak, and a mid-week (Wednesday) progress update rather than a Sunday-night one.
7. **Measure learning, not just progress.** Log actual watch time and add an automatic alert for bulk updates and for any day over 16 hrs. About a quarter of credited records arrive faster than the content could be watched, and the 26 Oct bulk update would have handed out 23 hampers.
8. **Publish the tie-break rule up front** so the top-3 result can't be disputed. Then check November activity against the July–August baseline to see whether the habit stuck after the rewards were handed out.

Data quality and method

Four issues were found. Two of them change the results materially.

Issue	Detail	Action
Bulk system completion	8 lessons (1303–1308, 1311, 1314) were marked 100% complete for all 330 users on 26 Oct, and for 98% of users all 8 landed within 5 seconds. That's 4.27 hrs and 8 lessons per user, enough for a weekly goal on its own. These lessons appear nowhere else in the data.	Removed all 2,640 rows. With them, week 7 shows 100% goal completion and 197 achievers instead of 174.
Impossible daily hours	4 users have more than 24 hrs of learning credited in one day: user_013 (59.3 hrs on 14 Aug), user_224 (38.0), user_266 (32.2, twice) and user_292 (27.7 on 17 Sep).	Excluded from analysis and rewards. Sent to CS for manual review. 3 of them would otherwise qualify for a hamper.
Completion above 100%	One record shows 120% (user_256, lesson_1330).	Capped at 100.
Date parsing in the xlsx	challenge_start_date reads as 9 Dec 2022, and batch_week mixes text and dates.	Used the CSV copy of the users table.

I didn't apply an IQR or z-score cut to total hours. The challenge rewards maximum hours, so the top tail is exactly where the winners are, and an IQR fence would have removed all three of them.

Rules as applied

- Learning time per record = day completion % × lesson duration.
- A lesson counts as completed on the day its overall completion first reaches 100%. Re-watching a finished lesson adds hours but not another completion. Counting re-completions as well would add 3 achievers.
- Weeks run Monday to Sunday. Week 1 = 12–18 Sep. The baseline is the 8 weeks from 18 Jul to 11 Sep.
- Weekly goal = 5+ lessons and 3.5+ hrs in the week. Target = 5+ weekly goals and 20+ hrs in total.

All numbers come from a Python pipeline. The headline figures (achievers, top 3, outliers, average hours) were rebuilt independently in SQL and match.